

Modem woes

Having to dial repeatedly when you want to get online can be a real pain in the neck. But guess who's more irritated than you are? Your modem! If it



could speak it would let you know—and maybe this is what it would say.
Contributed by: D. Bose,
via e-mail

Secretaries 2.0

What's the best way to avoid work? Get yourself a secretary! And what's even better? A computerised secretary! Question is—do you have to pay them?!



Your chance to
BACKBYTE!

Highlight the lighter side of computing. Mail your contributions to Backbyte

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Bottom of the Charts

Overcome by connectivity hassles,
Kamil Merchant takes poetic licence:

Socho kabhi aisa ho to kya ho...
Bahar se koi mail na aa sake
Andar se koi data na ja sake
Socho kabhi aisa ho to kya ho
Socho kabhi aisa ho to kya ho
Hum Tum ek Network pe logged ho
Aur Server Down ho jaye
Resources se Kaho ke NT chod de
Unix lay aai
Hum Tum
Aage hai 4GL ka mela ...
Baba Mujhe Dar Lagta Hai
Peeche hai Cobol ka Thela- ... Hmm.
Kyon Dara rahe ho
Aage hai 4GL ka mela
Peeche hai Cobol ka Thela
US bhi jana hai mushkil
Bench pe rahana bhi mushkil
Socho kabhi aisa ho to kya ho
Socho kabhi aisa ho to kya ho
Hum Tum Solitair khel rahe ho
Aur Page Fault Aa jaye..
Hum Tum...

RETRO

UNIVAC

The Universal Automatic Computer (UNIVAC) was developed between 1946-51 to do tabulation work for the US Census Bureau. While it was seen as a Godsend in government circles, it was not until the US presidential election of 1952 that it made its universal claim to fame.

While the results were being processed at the election headquarters, the media had submitted data to the UNIVAC asking it to predict the outcome. The resulting printout informed them that Eisenhower would win. But the newscasters, unwilling to present a result that they found unbelievable, broadcast that even the machine was "stumped" on this issue. It was a sheepish newscaster who later appeared on TV to inform audiences that UNIVAC had indeed predicted the election correctly, but the news media had been unwilling to stake their reputation on the machine's calculations.

Readers Rants

Long Gone

Here's an old advertisement for a so called 'most powerful computer ever'! How powerful? Well, 20 MHz Intel

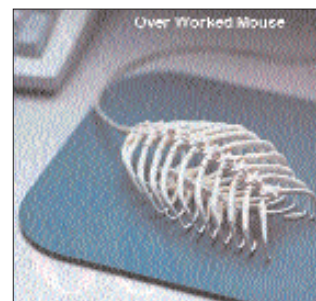


80386 Microprocessor, VGA graphics card, 2MB RAM, 16 MB capacity! Boy, oh boy! Have we come a long way!
Contributed by: Mikhail Esteves,
via e-mail

Hardware Engineer doing time!

Throw a hardware engineer in jail. Give him a loaf of bread, a knife and all the time in the world. And what do you get? This!

Contributed by: Manu Khanna,
via e-mail



Done to death!

The next time you smell a rat at work, it's probably a mouse! No, not the four legged kind, but the one on your

table connected to your desktop. This little guy does do a lot of work...and here's proof of what could happen if you overwork him.

Contributed by: Ramanujam, via e-mail